# Ask the tutor

A tutor that has read the course's notes and nothing else — answers with its sources shown, checked — and how to interrogate any AI well. Then Graham and Carver, side by side.

We grade decisions, not outcomes.

Education, not advice.

0:00 — HARVEST

# The question you brought

### Round the room

Each student reads their question aloud. On the board, three columns as they come: the course can answer this · the course cannot · not sure.

### Say nothing yet

The hour decides the sorting. By 0:40 the room will know which column each question belongs in, and why.

### Tonight

What the tutor is and is not; ask it live and check it; the five habits of asking an AI well; then the gate — Graham and Carver read side by side, and what it said the first night.

An answer with a citation you can check is a claim. An answer without one is a rumour.

# Five facts about the page

| | |
|---|---|
| **It has read the notes** | the ten lesson plans, the two week-5 segments, the four kit documents — the student's sections, about 160 passages. Not the internet, not the news, not your account, not tonight's prices. |
| **It finds passages by words** | “how is the stop calculated?” → stop, calculated → the passages that use them most (stemmed). Ask in the course's words; other words find nothing, and it says so. |
| **It answers from them only, and cites** | [L8.9]: lesson 8, passage 9, on every paragraph. Click the tag; the passage is on the page below the answer. |
| **It is checked** | a passage it was not given → flagged · a number in no passage it read → flagged · a tip (buy, sell, should, undervalued, a target) → the answer is withheld and the passages shown. |
| **It is anonymous and rationed** | no code asked; the question and the outcome are kept so the class can see what was asked; sixty a day on the course's key, then the passages only. |

The citations are not decoration. They are the whole point.

0:25 — ASK IT, LIVE

# Find the sentence, find the number

### Three from the gold set

Projected, each checked by a pair: open the citation, find the claim in the passage, find the number. “The stop gap is ½ × instrument risk × entry: $31.72 on $348.91” — is $31.72 there?

### Three of the room's own

From the board's first column. Then — on purpose — “Should I buy Coca-Cola?”: a decline, or an answer in process terms with no tip; if it slips, the page withholds the answer and prints why.

### One the notes cannot answer

“What will Apple's shares do next year?” The model should say the notes do not cover it — the rule reads the price, it does not predict it. A confident number here would be the fault to catch.

Hands up for anyone whose answer carried a flag. That is the best homework in the room.

WHAT THE PAGE CATCHES

# Three ways an answer can be wrong

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Flagged by the checks: paragraph 1 cites a passage it was not given (P9). Treat that part as unverified.

Flagged by the checks: paragraph 2 has a number that is in none of the passages ($40). Treat that part as unverified.

The AI's answer was withheld by the course's checks (advice-shaped language: “you should buy”). The passages it read are below; the answer is in them.
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## An invented source

The model was given six passages, P1–P6, and cited a seventh. The claim may be true; it is unverified, and the page says so.

## A number from nowhere

Every figure in the answer must be in a passage it read, to the last digit. $40 is not; the paragraph is marked. The sentence will be fluent either way — the number is where it shows.

## A tip

Buy, sell, hold, should, undervalued, a target, a forecast. The answer is withheld; the passages are shown. The course does not say what to buy, and neither does its tutor.

# Five habits for asking any AI

| | |
|---|---|
| **1 · Use the source's words** | Retrieval matches words. “Instrument risk”, “the stop gap”, “the 12% target”, “the defensive screen” find the course's passages. A general chatbot has the same weakness, dressed better. |
| **2 · One thing at a time** | “What is the stop gap, and when does the stop move?” beats “explain stops and sizing and everything”. A long question retrieves the wrong passages and the answer blends them. |
| **3 · Ask for the passage, then read it** | Here the page does it for you. Elsewhere: “where does that come from?” — and refuse an answer that cannot say. A source you cannot open is not a source. |
| **4 · Check the number, not the sentence** | The sentence will be fluent either way. $31.72 is in the passage or it is not. |
| **5 · Distrust fluency** | The better the prose, the more it is worth checking. A confident wrong answer is the product that sells scams. The flags are a training wheel; the habit is the point. |

What it cannot know: tonight's prices, your account, tax, anything after the notes were written — and anything about you. A confident answer on those is wrong by construction.

0:55 — THE GATE

# Graham says what. Carver says when, and how much.

### Graham, first

The screens, from the accounts, slowly: the defensive seven or the enterprising six. A name must pass one — a survivor, or a candidate — to be in the gate at all.

### Carver, second

The rule, from prices, nightly: the name must be LONG. Then the Starter System sizes it (12% ÷ N) and the stop closes it. The ticket is yours.

### Read together

GATE on the signals page: passes a screen and long. near: one Graham test short and long — a reading list, not a pick. The watchlist says it in sentences, tonight.

The signals page now shows each company's Graham tests passed beside its state: 4/7 · 5/6. Hover for the failed ones.

THE FIRST NIGHT IT WAS READ

# 6 November 2026: the gate was empty

### Nothing passed

No company passed either Graham screen: eight defensive near misses, two enterprising. Every name the rule was long on — nineteen that night — failed both price tests: P/E ≤ 15 and P/B ≤ 1.5.

### An empty gate is a result

The rule's answer was cash, and a journal line that says “waiting”. Graham's bars were set in the 1970s; against a 2026 US large-cap market they say “nothing is cheap” — a statement about the market and the bars, not a fault, and not a reason to loosen them tonight (that is a second rule).

### The size decides N

A relaxed, labelled example — the longs that passed the most defensive tests, on $10,000: four names failed the 1% round-trip cost rule on two; three worked (DAL 10, JNJ 5, KO 20 — 11.7% of the budget, 58% cash by design). Arithmetic, not a list.

Four instruments on $10,000 is not a bigger portfolio. It is two positions too small to trade.

THE WATCHLIST, IN SENTENCES

# Statements about tonight, never a pick

The gate tonight: nothing. No company passes either Graham screen, so there is no name the course would ticket by both rules — the rule's answer is cash, and a journal line that says "waiting".

No near miss is long tonight.

19 names are long on the rule; 19 of them fail both screens. By defensive tests passed, the nearest: … Lesson 10's point: P/E ≤ 15 and P/B ≤ 1.5 are 1970s bars against a 2026 US large-cap market, and the rule does not care.

48 small caps still warming up (fewer than 128 closes); the nearest has … — ticketable once it has 128 and no quarantine.

## Four tables

The gate (passes a screen and long) · near misses that are long, with the failed test named · the rule's longs that fail both, by tests passed · small caps on their way to 128 closes.

## The 6 Nov shape

Empty, empty, nineteen, forty-eight. The night this deck was written the shape was the same; the counts move nightly — read the page, not the slide.

## Still not advice

A name on the page is not a recommendation to buy; an empty gate is not a recommendation to wait. It is what the rules say, written down.

1:10 — LIVE

# Your question, tonight

[ course URL ]/tutor

[ course URL ]/watchlist

1 · Ask one question in the course's words. Read the answer. Click one tag; find the sentence; find the number. Tell your pair what you found.

2 · If the answer carries a flag, or a claim you cannot find in the passage: write the question and the passage id on the board. The record gets it after class.

3 · Ask one the notes cannot answer. Watch what the page does — the honest “the notes don't cover this” is the behaviour a scam never has.

4 · Open the watchlist. Say the gate's state in one word. Write it in the journal — that is this week's Monday line.

# Monday: five minutes, with the watchlist

### Monday evening, in this order

/signals for your instrument → your page: the stop, the stamp, the report → the journal → (maybe) a ticket. New: a glance at /watchlist and the gate's state in one word; a question to the tutor before class, with the citation you checked.

### 1 · Three questions, checked

In the course's words, each with one citation checked: the passage id, the sentence, the number. A flag is the best homework in the room — bring it. 2 · One question the notes cannot answer, and what the page did.

### 3 · The Monday line · 4 · Week 11

The routine with the watchlist line in the journal. Read the week-11 preview on the ledger; bring your DeGiro questions. No accounts opened.

Close with the sentence: we grade decisions, not outcomes.

GO DEEPER — FREE, FOREVER, OPTIONAL

# Where the tutor comes from

The corpus is the repository; the index is a table; the checks are week 6's; the gate is two files you already know:

NOTES  docs/lessons/*.md and kit/*.md — the passages the tutor reads are these files, cut by scripts/notes-chunker.mjs; `npm run seed-notes` writes them to the database

INDEX  SQLite full-text search (FTS5) in D1 — decision #3; porter stemming; a plain word match when the index is absent (src/lib/tutor.ts, rankByTerms)

CHECKS  src/lib/explain.ts — the number check and the advice families of week 6, reused on the answer (checkAnswer); the gold set in docs/lessons/week-10-gold-set.md

GATE  src/lib/graham.ts (weeks 4–5) and src/lib/signals.ts (week 7), read together by src/lib/gate.ts — no new rule; the watchlist's sentences in describeWatchlist

PAGE  /tutor · /api/tutor · /api/tutor/recent · /watchlist · /api/watchlist · the Graham column on /signals